



MyAfricanDishCompanion

Africa's kitchen, explained.

A warm, practical cooking companion for discovering West African dishes, understanding ingredients, and cooking with confidence.

PRODUCT PITCH • V1 FOCUSED ON WEST AFRICA

The big idea

DISCOVER

Find dishes by country, category or ingredient.

UNDERSTAND

Know what you need, how much, and what an unfamiliar ingredient looks like.

COOK

Follow clear steps, with technique explained when it matters.

The product is deliberately more human than a recipe database: it is designed to feel like a knowledgeable relative beside you in the kitchen.

THE PROBLEM

A real cooking problem

Recipes are imprecise

“A handful” and “to taste” can be meaningful to an experienced cook—but frustrating to a beginner.

Ingredients are a barrier

Diaspora cooks may not know where to find key ingredients, or what to use when one is unavailable.

Technique gets lost

A recipe can say what to do without explaining why the step matters.

The journey

Discovery, ingredient confidence, cooking and meal planning are designed as one connected experience.

MyAfricanDishCompanion brings those needs into a single, focused cooking journey.

TARGET USERS

Who it is for

Diaspora cooks

People who grew up around African food but never learned the exact techniques—and now cook where ingredients may be harder to find.

Curious newcomers

People who have tasted West African food and want a clear, approachable path to cooking it themselves.

West African home cooks

Home cooks looking for a reliable reference for dishes they already know, plus a way to try dishes from neighbouring countries.

Launch scope: West African dishes across multiple countries, including Nigeria, Ghana and Senegal.

HOW IT WORKS

One continuous journey

01

DISCOVER

02

REVIEW

03

PREPARE

04

COOK

Browse by category or country → open a dish → review ingredients and substitutions → start cooking → mark it cooked for next time.

Also: plan a meal from pairings → shopping list, or return to My Cookbook.

CORE FEATURES

The product experience

Discovery

Browse by category or country; search by dish or ingredient. Each card shows flag, time, difficulty and dietary tags.

Dish pages

Finished-dish photo, key-ingredient visuals, origin context, and dietary tags with short adaptation tips.

Ingredients

Quantities for a default serving size, a metric/cups toggle, and helpful substitutions with trade-offs.

Cooking

Numbered plain-language steps, time estimates and embedded “why” tips.

Meal planning

2–3 suggested pairings that link straight to each dish, plus one shopping list grouped by dish.

Personalization

My Cookbook favorites and a simple cooked history.

The signature moment: Start Cooking

Start Cooking

Step 4 of 9

Build the stew base

Cook until the mixture deepens in colour and the oil begins to separate. Don't rush this stage: it concentrates the flavour.

NEXT

- Large, focused text
- One step at a time
- Estimated time
- Why-it-matters tips
- Back / next navigation

Two modes keep the product useful both before cooking and while cooking: Full recipe for reading ahead, Start Cooking for active preparation.

Ingredient confidence

RECOGNIZE IT

Visuals help users identify unfamiliar ingredients such as egusi seeds or uda pods before they buy them.

REPLACE IT

Substitution guidance gives a practical alternative when an ingredient is hard to find.

UNDERSTAND THE TRADE-OFF

The app explains what changes—flavour, texture or authenticity—rather than pretending substitutes are identical.

Example principle: if palm oil is unavailable, offer a practical alternative and clearly explain what the cook will lose or change.

More than recipes

Every dish has context.

Short cultural and origin notes can explain where a dish comes from, when it is traditionally eaten, and why it matters—without turning the cooking experience into a history essay.

- Preserves context alongside technique
- Makes unfamiliar food less intimidating
- Supports respectful, accurate storytelling
- Leaves room for regional and family variations

Built for repeat use

1

SAVE

Favorite dishes become
My Cookbook.

2

COOK

Mark dishes actually
made.

3

PAIR

Discover complementary
dishes.

4

SHOP

Build one shopping list,
grouped by dish.

The goal is not just a successful recipe lookup. It is a companion people can build a relationship with over repeated cook sessions.

Focused launch, expandable foundation

V1: WEST AFRICA

Nigeria, Ghana, Senegal and other West African dishes across rice dishes, soups & stews, swallow, snacks and small chops.

DEEPEN THE EXPERIENCE

More dishes, regional variations, deeper personalization, cook notes and ratings.

EXPAND AFRICA

East, North, Central and Southern African cuisines can be added after the launch foundation is proven.

The product architecture and content model can grow without requiring every region to be solved on day one.

WHY THIS PRODUCT CAN STAND APART

Positioning

EXPERIENCE	COMMON APPROACH	MYAFRICANDISHCOMPANION
Generic recipe database	Large selection	Focused African cooking context
Food content / blogs	Inspiration + recipes	Structured ingredients + cooking flow
Standalone cooking instructions	Step-by-step help	Discovery + shopping + personalization
Ingredient substitution	Occasional tips	A core, explicit confidence layer

This is product positioning based on the V1 design—not a claim of a completed competitive market study.

Potential paths to sustainability

FREEMIUM

Core dish discovery and cooking free; premium could unlock deeper personalization or advanced planning.

PARTNERSHIPS

African food brands, ingredient suppliers, cultural organizations and culinary partners.

COMMERCE / AFFILIATE

Relevant ingredient and kitchen-product referrals where commercially appropriate.

PREMIUM CONTENT

Curated collections, regional culinary journeys or advanced cooking experiences.

These are possible models for exploration, not commitments or revenue projections.

Lean technology by design

LOCAL JSON

Dish content ships with the app in data/dishes.json. No backend is required for the current prototype.

LOCAL STORAGE

Favorites, cooked history, shopping list and measurement preference persist in the browser.

READY TO EVOLVE

Hosted database/auth can be introduced for cross-device accounts and synchronization if necessary.

Current decision: keep JSON + localStorage for V1. It minimizes setup, matches the local-only prototype, and avoids adding infrastructure before it creates user value.

ASSUMPTIONS & RISKS

Risks we're managing

Cultural accuracy

Dish origins and “traditional” claims can be contested across regions and families.

Safeguard: content is reviewed for accuracy and sensitivity before publishing at scale.

Misleading substitutions

A substitute can change flavour and texture more than a cook expects.

Safeguard: every substitution carries an honest trade-off note, written with culinary judgment.

ASSUMPTIONS WE ARE TESTING

- West African cuisine has enough breadth and recognition to sustain a compelling V1.
- Users will accept ingredient substitutions when clearly told the trade-offs.

A practical roadmap

NOW

West African V1

Discovery • recipes •
substitutions • cooking
modes • shopping •
favorites

NEXT

Depth

More dishes • regional
variations • stronger
personalization • spice-
level customization • cook
notes

THEN

Intelligence

Ingredient-aware
recommendations • richer
meal planning (weekly
planning, cost estimates)
• summed shopping lists •
hands-free cooking

LATER

Pan-African

East • North • Central •
Southern Africa •
community content

Recommended future feature

Cook With What You Have

Enter—or eventually photograph—the ingredients already in your kitchen. The app suggests African dishes that fit what is available, adjusts quantities where practical, and builds a missing-ingredients list.

- Reduces the “what can I make?” barrier
- Turns pantry ingredients into discovery
- Creates a natural bridge to shopping
- Could become a powerful personalization layer

STATUS: RECOMMENDED FUTURE FEATURE — NOT PART OF CURRENT V1

SUCCESS METRICS

How success can be measured

Cooking completion

% of users who complete Start Cooking after opening it.

Favorites

Number of dishes saved per active user.

30-day return

Users returning to browse or cook a second dish within 30 days.

Search usage

Share of sessions using search, indicating how users discover dishes.

These metrics are designed to test whether the product is useful, understandable and habit-forming—not simply whether it attracts initial visits.

The opportunity

MyAfricanDishCompanion can become a practical digital gateway into African food: helping people discover dishes, understand ingredients, cook with confidence, and return for the next meal.

EARLY USERS

People willing to test real dishes and cooking flows.

CONTENT PARTNERS

Cooks, chefs, cultural voices and ingredient experts who can strengthen the library.

STRATEGIC SUPPORT

Partners, collaborators and resources that can help take a focused V1 into a scalable product.

Make African cooking easier to discover, understand, cook, preserve and share.

MyAfricanDishCompanion

West African cooking, explained with warmth and confidence.

PITCH DECK • OCTOBER 2026